

Modern India to 1857 - The Foundation Track

Chapter F5.9 — From Zero: The Company's Rise to Power, the Land Revenue Settlements, Economic Transformation, the Social Reform Movements, and the Revolt of 1857

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NOTE · HOW TO USE THIS DOCUMENT

Modern India begins here, and the chapter is organised around one question: how did a trading company come to govern a subcontinent, and what did it do once it had? Session 1 takes the acquisition of power - Plassey, Buxar, the grant of the Diwani, and the two devices, Subsidiary Alliance and Doctrine of Lapse, by which the rest of India was absorbed without much fighting. Session 2 takes the land revenue settlements, which are the most consequential administrative decisions of the period and whose effects outlast British rule, together with commercialisation, de-industrialisation and the drain. Session 3 takes the social and religious reform movements, each paired to a founder, a year and a cause. Session 4 takes the tribal and peasant uprisings that preceded 1857 and then the Revolt itself - its causes, its centres and leaders, why it failed, and the constitutional settlement of 1858 that replaced Company rule with the Crown. Study time 4 hours.

This is the FOUNDATION layer. The characterisation of the Revolt of 1857 is genuinely contested - sepoy mutiny, feudal reaction, or first war of independence - and competing readings are given rather than a verdict. Figures for de-industrialisation and the drain are estimates from a contested literature and are presented as such. Dates of legislation and of the founding of associations are those conventionally accepted. Assessments of individual reformers reflect the standard scholarly position and are not offered as moral judgements.

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0. Why the Modern Period Is Studied Differently

The ancient chapters were about recognising things. This one is about causes and consequences, because that is how the modern period is asked.

WHY THIS EXISTS · WHAT CHANGES WHEN YOU REACH THE MODERN PERIOD

F5.1 established that history questions test **recognition**, and that has held for eight chapters. **The modern period is where that begins to shift, and you should know why.**

- 1 The evidence is abundant rather than scarce.** For the Harappans we had objects; here we have legislation, revenue records, newspapers, parliamentary debates and private letters. **So questions can ask about causes, provisions and consequences, not merely names**
- 2 The institutions still exist.** The land revenue systems, the courts, the railways, the universities and much of the administrative vocabulary of your own service date from this period. **This is the first chapter of Module 5 that describes the state you work for**
- 3 Dates matter more.** Legislation has years, and the years are asked

But do not over-correct. The paper is still a 120-question objective test, so **the questions remain mostly pairings - a settlement to its author, a reform society to its founder, a rebellion to its region.** What changes is that a **"why" question is now possible**, and Sessions 2 and 4 are written so you can answer one.

The user-specific note. You told me history is one of your three weak subjects, and modern India is where that matters least, **because this is the period an SBI officer already half knows:** the Permanent Settlement is a credit-risk decision, de-industrialisation is a terms-of-trade story, and the drain is a balance-of-payments argument. **Session 2 is written to exploit that.**

PYQ CONNECTION · WHERE THE MARKS SIT

- 1 HIGHEST yield - the three land revenue settlements. Permanent Settlement, Ryotwari, Mahalwari** with their authors, regions and mechanics. A near-certain question, and it also feeds economy questions
 - 2 HIGHEST yield - the reform movements. Brahmo Samaj, Arya Samaj, Ramakrishna Mission, Prarthana Samaj, Satyashodhak Samaj, Aligarh** - founder, year and one idea each. Pure pairing, and there are a lot of them
 - 3 HIGH yield - 1857: the immediate cause, Mangal Pandey, Meerut**, and above all the **centre-to-leader pairings**
 - 4 HIGH yield - the two annexation devices: Subsidiary Alliance (Wellesley) and Doctrine of Lapse (Dalhousie)**
 - 5 HIGH yield - the social legislation with years: sati 1829, Widow Remarriage 1856, Age of Consent 1891**
 - 6 MODERATE - Plassey and Buxar**, and the constitutional Acts from 1773 to 1858
 - 7 MODERATE - the uprisings: Santhal, Munda under Birsa, Indigo revolt, Deccan riots**
- The single most efficient thing in this chapter is the 1857 leader-to-centre table.** Six or seven pairings, unmistakable, and they have been asked in every format.

STUDY SESSION · CHAPTER F5.9 - THE FOUR SESSIONS

- 1 **Session 1 - How the Company took power:** Plassey to the Diwani, the constitutional Acts, and the two devices of annexation (Section 1)
 - 2 **Session 2 - Land and the economy:** the three settlements, commercialisation, de-industrialisation, the drain, and the modernising infrastructure (Section 2)
 - 3 **Session 3 - Social and religious reform:** the movements, their founders, and the legislation they produced (Section 3)
 - 4 **Session 4 - Resistance and the Revolt:** tribal and peasant uprisings, then 1857 - causes, leaders, failure and consequences (Section 4)
- Then **42 graded questions**.

1. Session 1 - How the Company Took Power



A chartered trading company acquires the right to collect the revenue of Bengal, and everything else follows from the money.

MUST MASTER · FROM TRADE TO TERRITORY - THE SEQUENCE THAT MATTERS

- 1 **The English East India Company was chartered in 1600** by Elizabeth I, with a monopoly of English trade east of the Cape. **Its first factory in India was at SURAT, 1613**
- 2 **BATTLE OF PLASSEY, 1757 - Robert Clive** defeated **Siraj-ud-Daulah**, Nawab of Bengal, largely by **subverting his commander MIR JAFAR** rather than by fighting. **Plassey is less a military victory than a successful conspiracy**, and saying so is accurate rather than cynical
- 3 **BATTLE OF BUXAR, 1764** - the decisive one. The Company defeated the **combined forces of Mir Qasim of Bengal, Shuja-ud-Daulah of Awadh and the Mughal emperor SHAH ALAM II**. **Buxar established British military supremacy in northern India in a way Plassey did not**, because here they beat a real coalition including the emperor
- 4 **GRANT OF THE DIWANI, 1765** - Shah Alam II granted the Company the **Diwani**, the right to collect the revenue of **Bengal, Bihar and Orissa**. **This is the constitutional turning point: the Company became a revenue authority, which is to say a government**
- 5 **DUAL GOVERNMENT (1765-1772)**, Clive's arrangement - **the Company held the revenue (diwani) and the Nawab retained administration and law and order (nizamat)**. **Responsibility and power were separated, and the result was a catastrophe culminating in the Bengal famine of 1770. Warren Hastings ended it in 1772**

The examinable logic, and it is worth holding as a chain: Plassey gave influence, Buxar gave supremacy, and the Diwani gave revenue - and revenue is what paid for the army that took the rest of India. The Company conquered India substantially with Indian money, which is the central and most quotable fact of the period.

1.1 The constitutional Acts, and the two devices of annexation

Act	Year	What it did
Regulating Act	1773	The first parliamentary intervention in Company affairs. Created a Governor-General of Bengal (Warren Hastings the first) with a council of four, and a Supreme Court at Calcutta . Established the principle that Parliament could regulate the Company

Act	Year	What it did
Pitt's India Act	1784	Created the BOARD OF CONTROL to supervise the Company's civil, military and revenue affairs. Established DUAL CONTROL - the Company traded and administered, the Crown supervised - which is the fact asked
Charter Act	1813	Ended the Company's monopoly of Indian trade (except tea and the China trade), and allotted one lakh rupees a year for education - the first such provision
Charter Act	1833	Ended the Company's commercial functions entirely , making it a purely administrative body. Made the Governor-General of Bengal the GOVERNOR-GENERAL OF INDIA (William Bentinck the first). Provided that no Indian be disqualified from office by religion, birth or colour - a provision honoured mainly in the breach
Charter Act	1853	Separated the legislative and executive functions of the Governor-General's council, and introduced open competition for the civil service , ending patronage appointment
Government of India Act	1858	Abolished the Company and transferred government to the CROWN . Created a Secretary of State for India with a Council of India, and retitled the Governor-General as VICEROY . This is the consequence of 1857 and belongs to Session 4

Company rule: the principal Acts of Parliament

MUST MASTER · THE TWO DEVICES - SUBSIDIARY ALLIANCE AND DOCTRINE OF LAPSE

Most of India was annexed without direct conquest, through two administrative instruments. Both are asked constantly, and the distinction is simple once stated.

SUBSIDIARY ALLIANCE - associated with **LORD WELLESLEY (1798-1805)**. An Indian ruler accepting it agreed to:

- 1 **Accept a British force stationed in his territory, and pay for its maintenance**
- 2 **Surrender control of his foreign relations** to the Company
- 3 **Accept a British Resident** at his court
- 4 **Employ no European of any other nationality** without Company consent
- 5 In return, the Company **guaranteed him against external attack and internal rebellion**

Why it was so effective, and this is the analytical point: the ruler paid for the army that contained him. The subsidy was usually set above what the state could afford, so **arrears accumulated, and territory was ceded in settlement of the debt. A protection guarantee also removed his need to maintain his own army, so his capacity to resist decayed while his obligations grew. As a banker you will recognise the structure precisely: it is a loan on unaffordable terms secured against the borrower's assets, with the lender controlling the borrower's other relationships.** States that accepted: **Hyderabad (the first, 1798), Mysore, Awadh, and the Marathas after 1802.**

DOCTRINE OF LAPSE - associated with **LORD DALHOUSIE (1848-1856)**. If an Indian ruler died without a natural heir, his state "**lapsed**" to the Company - adopted heirs, valid under Hindu law and long accepted by the Mughals, were refused recognition.

- 1 Annexed under it: **Satara (the first, 1848), Jaitpur, Sambalpur, Udaipur, Jhansi (1853), Nagpur (1854)**
- 2 **AWADH was annexed in 1856 on a different ground - alleged misgovernment, not lapse. This distinction is a favourite question**, and the Awadh annexation was among the most resented acts of the period, because it dispossessed a loyal ally and unsettled the many sepoys recruited from Awadh

Hold the pair as: Wellesley made rulers dependent; Dalhousie dispossessed them. And note that both feed directly into 1857 - Jhansi and Awadh are on the lapse and misgovernment lists, and both became centres of the Revolt.

KNOW · THE WARS, AT RECOGNITION LEVEL ONLY

Do not study these in detail. Learn the opponent, the outcome and one name each; the stopping rule from F5.1 applies.

- 1 **ANGLO-MYSORE WARS** (four, 1767-1799) - against **Haidar Ali** and then **TIPU SULTAN**, who **died defending Srirangapatna in 1799**. **Tipu is the name to know**, and he is notable for modernising his army and for seeking French support
- 2 **ANGLO-MARATHA WARS** (three, 1775-1818) - ended with the **defeat of the Peshwa in 1818** and the extinction of Maratha power, completing what **Third Panipat 1761** from F5.7 had begun
- 3 **ANGLO-SIKH WARS** (two, 1845-1849) - after **Ranjit Singh's** death; ended with the **annexation of the Punjab in 1849**, the last major Indian territory to fall
- 4 **ANGLO-BURMESE WARS** - peripheral, and asked rarely

The one-line summary of the sequence, which is what a question actually wants: the south fell by 1799, the Marathas by 1818, and the Punjab by 1849 - so British paramountcy over the subcontinent was complete less than a decade before the Revolt. That timing is not a coincidence, and Session 4 explains why.

CHECK YOURSELF · SESSION 1

- 1 When was the Company chartered, and where was its first Indian factory?
- 2 Give the year, opponents and real mechanism of Plassey
- 3 Why does Buxar matter more than Plassey, and whom did the Company defeat there?
- 4 What was the Diwani, in what year was it granted, and by whom?
- 5 Explain Dual Government and what it produced
- 6 State what the Acts of 1773, 1784, 1813, 1833 and 1853 each did
- 7 Give the five terms of the Subsidiary Alliance, and why it was financially fatal
- 8 What was the Doctrine of Lapse, and on what different ground was Awadh annexed?
- 9 Give the three war sequences with their end dates, and the summary sentence

2. Session 2 - Land and the Economy ★★★★★

Three ways of collecting the same tax, with different consequences that are still visible. This is the session your own training makes easy.

2.1 The three land revenue settlements

Every colonial government's first question is who pays the tax and on what terms. The Company answered it three different ways in three parts of India, and the choice shaped rural society for two centuries.

Feature	PERMANENT SETTLEMENT	RYOTWARI	MAHALWARI
Also called	Zamindari, Istamrari	-	-
Associated with	LORD CORNWALLIS, 1793	Thomas MUNRO and Captain Read	Holt MACKENZIE and R. M. Bird
Where	Bengal, Bihar, Orissa , later Banaras and northern Madras - about a fifth of British India	MADRAS and BOMBAY presidencies, and Assam and Berar - about half	North-Western Provinces, Central Provinces, PUNJAB - about a third

Feature	PERMANENT SETTLEMENT	RYOTWARI	MAHALWARI
Who pays	The ZAMINDAR , recognised as proprietor	The individual cultivator (RYOT) directly	The village or MAHAL as a body , through its headmen
Amount	FIXED IN PERPETUITY - never to be revised	Revised periodically , conventionally every 20-30 years	Revised periodically
Share demanded	About 89 per cent of rental to the state, 11 per cent to the zamindar	High initially - often about 50 per cent of produce	Assessed on the estate as a whole
Key consequence	Created a landlord class with a permanent stake in British rule ; but the fixed demand meant the state lost the benefit of rising prices , while zamindars raised rents at will and evicted for arrears	No intermediary , but the state dealt directly with millions of cultivators , assessments were often over-pitched, and the ryot bore the whole risk of a bad harvest	Cumbersome to administer; joint village liability meant a defaulter's burden fell on his neighbours

The three land revenue settlements - the certain question of this chapter

FROM YOUR OWN WORLD · READ THE PERMANENT SETTLEMENT AS A CREDIT DECISION, BECAUSE THAT IS WHAT IT WAS

Cornwallis was solving a problem you deal with professionally: **an unfamiliar borrower base, no reliable data, and a need for predictable cash flow.**

His solution was to fix the amount in perpetuity, and its logic was exactly a banker's logic.

A fixed demand gives the state **certain, predictable revenue** and removes the cost of periodic assessment. It also **transfers all risk of variation to the intermediary** - the zamindar owes the same sum whether the harvest is good or bad. And by making the zamindar a **proprietor with a heritable, saleable interest**, Cornwallis expected him to behave like an improving landlord and invest, because he would capture the gains.

Three things went wrong, and each is a recognisable failure mode:

- 1 The demand was set too high and was inflexible.** In the early decades **large numbers of zamindars defaulted and their estates were sold** - the state got its certainty and destroyed its counterparties. **This is what happens when a fixed obligation meets a volatile income stream**
- 2 The expected investment did not happen.** The zamindar could increase his income far more easily by **raising the rent of the tenant** than by improving the land. **The incentive pointed at rent extraction, not productivity** - and nothing in the settlement protected the tenant
- 3 Fixing the demand in perpetuity meant that as prices and output rose over the next century, the entire gain accrued to zamindars and none to the state. The government eventually regretted it, which is precisely why Ryotwari and Mahalwari were not permanent**

The general lesson, and it is a fair interview answer: the settlement optimised for the collector's certainty rather than the producer's capacity, and it created an intermediary whose interests were opposed to improvement. That is a sentence about incentive design, and it is the honest analytical content of the topic.

MUST MASTER · COMMERCIALISATION, DE-INDUSTRIALISATION AND THE DRAIN

COMMERCIALISATION OF AGRICULTURE. Cultivators shifted from food grains to **cash crops for export - indigo, opium, cotton, jute, tea, oilseeds.**

- 1 **It was not a free market choice.** Revenue was demanded **in cash**, so the cultivator had to sell; and in the case of **indigo** the system of advances tied him to the planter
- 2 **The consequence was vulnerability:** a peasant growing cotton for Lancashire is exposed to a world price he cannot see, and **cannot eat his crop when the price collapses.** This is a genuine cause of the famines
- 3 **Note the connection: the indigo system produced the INDIGO REVOLT of 1859-60 in Bengal,** which Session 4 covers

DE-INDUSTRIALISATION. India entered the period as **the world's largest producer of cotton textiles** and left it as an exporter of raw cotton and an importer of cloth. **The mechanism is what matters, and it is three things acting together:**

- 1 **British industrial competition** - mechanised Lancashire mills undercut handloom weavers on price
- 2 **Tariff asymmetry - Indian goods entering Britain faced heavy duties while British goods entered India at nominal rates.** This is the decisive element, and it is the reason "free competition" is not an adequate description
- 3 **Loss of court patronage** as Indian states were annexed, which removed the market for luxury craft

THE DRAIN OF WEALTH - the theory associated with DADABHAI NAOROJI, in Poverty and Un-British Rule in India, and with R. C. Dutt.

- 1 **The claim: a part of India's national product was transferred to Britain annually without any equivalent economic return.** Its components were **the Home Charges** (administration in London, pensions of British officials, and interest on debt raised in Britain), **profits and remittances of British officials and firms, and the cost of wars fought for imperial purposes**
- 2 **The mechanism was India's export surplus:** India exported more than it imported, and **the surplus was not received as imports or gold but absorbed in these unrequited payments. In your vocabulary: a persistent current-account surplus offset by an invisible transfer, so the country ran a trade surplus and got nothing for it**
- 3 **Naoroji's political significance is as large as his economics:** the drain theory gave the early nationalists **an economic case against British rule** rather than only a political grievance, and F5.10 shows what they did with it
- 4 **The magnitude is contested and estimates vary widely. State the mechanism confidently and the figures as estimates**

THE MODERNISING INFRASTRUCTURE - and hold both sides of it. The **first railway ran from Bombay to Thane in 1853, under Dalhousie, along with the telegraph and a reorganised postal system. Dalhousie is conventionally called the maker of modern India for these.** But note their design: **the lines ran from the interior to the ports, which is the geometry of extraction rather than of an internal market,** and they were built on a **guaranteed-return system** in which **the Indian government underwrote investors' profits,** so the risk was Indian and the return British. **The honest verdict: genuinely modernising infrastructure, built for imperial purposes, and paid for by India.**

CHECK YOURSELF · SESSION 2

- 1 Give all three settlements with author, region, who paid, and whether the demand was fixed or revised
- 2 Why did Cornwallis fix the demand in perpetuity, and what three things went wrong?
- 3 Why did zamindars not invest in improvement?
- 4 What forced cultivators into cash crops, and why did that increase vulnerability?
- 5 Name the three mechanisms of de-industrialisation, and say which was decisive
- 6 Who formulated the drain theory, in which book, and what were its three components?
- 7 By what mechanism did the drain operate?
- 8 Give the year and route of the first railway, and state both sides of the infrastructure verdict

3. Session 3 - Social and Religious Reform ★★★★★

A generation of Indians who accepted parts of the colonial critique of their own society and set out to answer it. Learn each as founder, year and one idea.

START FROM ZERO · WHAT THE REFORM MOVEMENTS WERE REACTING TO, AND THE TWO STRATEGIES

The nineteenth-century reform movements arose from a specific collision: educated Indians encountered **western liberal ideas and Christian missionary criticism** at the same moment as their own society's practices - **sati, child marriage, enforced widowhood, untouchability, purdah** - were being held up as evidence of civilisational inferiority.

Two strategies emerged, and the distinction organises the whole session:

- 1 **REFORMIST** - accept that some practices are indefensible and change them, **using reason and often the colonial state's legislation. Brahmo Samaj, Prarthana Samaj, Aligarh movement**
- 2 **REVIVALIST** - argue that the objectionable practices are **later corruptions**, and that the remedy is a **return to a purer original tradition. Arya Samaj**, and in a different register the **Ramakrishna Mission**

Note that the two are not opposites in effect. A revivalist claim - "the Vedas do not sanction child marriage" - **can be more effective at changing behaviour than a reformist one**, because it does not require the believer to concede that his tradition was wrong. **Dayanand Saraswati's "back to the Vedas" was socially radical in practice**, opposing caste by birth and untouchability while claiming the highest possible authority for doing so. **That is a genuinely useful observation and it distinguishes a thoughtful answer from a list.**

3.1 The movements

Movement	Founder and year	What to know
BRAHMO SAMAJ	RAJA RAM MOHAN ROY, 1828	The starting point of Indian reform. Roy is conventionally called the father of the Indian Renaissance . Monotheist; opposed idolatry, caste and sati ; his campaign produced the abolition of SATI in 1829 under Lord William Bentinck . Founded the newspaper Sambad Kaumudi ; advocated English and modern scientific education . Later leaders Debendranath Tagore and Keshab Chandra Sen , under whom the Samaj split
Young Bengal	HENRY VIVIAN DEROZIO, 1820s	A radical rationalist group at Hindu College, Calcutta. Went further than Roy and had less influence - asked mainly for Derozio's name

Movement	Founder and year	What to know
Widow remarriage	ISHWAR CHANDRA VIDYASAGAR	Not a society but a campaign, and it produced the HINDU WIDOWS' REMARRIAGE ACT, 1856 . Also a pioneer of women's education . His method is worth noting: he argued from within the Sanskrit texts rather than against them
PRARTHANA SAMAJ	Atmaram Pandurang , 1867; led by M. G. RANADE and R. G. BHANDARKAR	Bombay, and essentially the Brahmo Samaj in western India , but more cautious and more socially practical - schools, orphanages, widow homes
ARYA SAMAJ	DAYANAND SARASWATI , 1875	"BACK TO THE VEDAS." Rejected idolatry, polytheism, priestly authority, child marriage and caste by birth ; accepted the Vedas as infallible. His book is the SATYARTH PRAKASH . Introduced SHUDDHI , a rite of reconversion, and built a large network of DAV schools . Revivalist in doctrine and radical in social effect
RAMAKRISHNA MISSION	SWAMI VIVEKANANDA , 1897, in the name of his teacher RAMAKRISHNA PARAMAHAMSA	Vedantic, and organised around service as worship . Vivekananda's address to the Parliament of Religions at CHICAGO in 1893 is the single most examinable event here. He gave Indian religious thought an international standing and Indian nationalism a language of self-respect
SATYASHODHAK SAMAJ	JYOTIBA PHULE , 1873	Maharashtra. The most important LOWER-CASTE movement of the period , attacking Brahmanical dominance directly. Wrote Gulamgiri ; with Savitribai Phule pioneered schools for girls and for untouchable children . Where the other movements reformed from above, this one organised from below
Theosophical Society	Blavatsky and Olcott , 1875 in New York, India from 1882; later ANNIE BESANT	Headquarters at Adyar , Madras. Praised Hindu and Buddhist thought; Besant founded the Central Hindu School at Banaras , which grew towards BHU, and later joined the national movement
ALIGARH movement	SIR SYED AHMAD KHAN	Modern education for Muslims , and reconciliation of Islam with modern science. Founded the Mohammedan Anglo-Oriental College at Aligarh, 1875 , which became Aligarh Muslim University . Loyalist in politics
Deoband movement	Muhammad Qasim Nanautavi and others, 1866	Orthodox and anti-colonial , and therefore the counterpoint to Aligarh - the pair is the standard question
Singh Sabha	1873, Amritsar	Sikh reform and education; the later Akali movement grew from this ground
SNDP	SRI NARAYANA GURU , Kerala	"One caste, one religion, one God for man." Organised the Ezhavas and campaigned for temple entry. The southern counterpart to Phule

The reform movements - founder, year, and the one idea

HIGH YIELD · THE SOCIAL LEGISLATION, WITH YEARS - A STANDARD QUESTION SET

- 1 **Abolition of SATI - 1829**, under **Bentinck**, following Ram Mohan Roy's campaign
- 2 **Abolition of slavery - 1843**
- 3 **HINDU WIDOWS' REMARRIAGE ACT - 1856**, following Vidyasagar's campaign
- 4 **AGE OF CONSENT ACT - 1891**, raising the age of consent for girls to twelve. **Bitterly opposed as interference in religion, and the controversy split the nationalist movement between reformers and those who held that social change must wait for political freedom** - a division F5.10 picks up
- 5 **Also of the period: the abolition of female infanticide (1795 and 1804 regulations)** and the suppression of human sacrifice among some tribal groups

And two educational milestones that belong here:

- 1 **MACAULAY'S MINUTE, 1835** - settled the question of the medium and content of state education in favour of **English and western learning**, over Sanskrit and Persian classical education. **The famous "filtration theory" was that education given to a thin upper layer would percolate downwards, and it did not**
- 2 **WOOD'S DESPATCH, 1854** - called the "**Magna Carta of English education in India**". Recommended a **department of education in each province, universities at Calcutta, Bombay and Madras** (founded **1857**), **grants-in-aid**, and **vernacular primary education**. **The 1857 university foundings are the fact asked**

BEGINNER MISTAKE · TWO THINGS TO GET RIGHT ABOUT THE REFORM MOVEMENTS

- 1 **They were limited in reach.** The movements were **overwhelmingly urban, upper-caste and English-educated**, and their direct membership was small. **Phule's and Narayana Guru's movements are the significant exceptions**, which is exactly why they matter. **An option claiming the reform movements transformed the condition of the mass of Indian women or of untouchables in this period overstates it**
- 2 **Do not present them as simply derivative of western liberalism.** They **selected** from it, argued from indigenous texts as often as from European ones, and **several were explicitly critical of colonial rule**. **Vidyasagar argued from the shastras; Dayanand from the Vedas**. The accurate description is a **negotiation** with western ideas rather than an adoption of them

The balanced verdict: the reform movements changed the terms of public debate, produced a body of enabling legislation, and created the educated class that made the national movement possible - while touching the lives of the rural majority only slightly. That last clause is what makes the answer credible.

CHECK YOURSELF · SESSION 3

- 1 What collision produced the reform movements, and what are the two strategies?
- 2 Why can a revivalist argument change behaviour more effectively than a reformist one?
- 3 Give founder and year for Brahmo Samaj, Arya Samaj, Prarthana Samaj, Satyashodhak Samaj and the Ramakrishna Mission
- 4 What is the Satyarth Prakash, and what is shuddhi?
- 5 What happened at Chicago in 1893, and why did it matter politically?
- 6 Who wrote Gulamgiri, and what did Phule and Savitribai pioneer?
- 7 Contrast Aligarh with Deoband
- 8 Give the years of sati abolition, widow remarriage and the Age of Consent Act
- 9 What did Macaulay's Minute settle, and what did Wood's Despatch recommend?
- 10 State the two corrections about the movements' reach and originality

4. Session 4 - Resistance, and the Revolt of 1857



A century of local risings, then one general explosion. The leader-to-centre table here is the cheapest set of marks in the chapter.

4.1 Tribal and peasant uprisings

The Revolt of 1857 was not the first resistance, and questions distinguish the two categories. Tribal risings were mostly against **loss of land, forest rights and the intrusion of outsiders**; peasant risings against **rent, revenue and the cash-crop system**.

Uprising	When	What to know
Sanyasi and Fakir	1770s-1800s	Bengal, following the famine of 1770 and restrictions on pilgrimage. The earliest of the series
Chuar and Kol	1798; 1831-32	Chotanagpur. The KOL rising was against the transfer of tribal land to outsider farmers and moneylenders
SANTHAL (Hul)	1855-56	The largest pre-Revolt rising , in the Damin-i-Koh of present-day Jharkhand, led by the brothers SIDHU and KANHU . Against moneylenders, revenue officials and traders. Immediately precedes 1857 and is asked in that context
Faraizi and Wahabi	1820s-1870s	Reform movements among Muslims in Bengal and the north-west that became agrarian and anti-British
Bhil	1818 onwards	Western India, recurring over decades
INDIGO REVOLT	1859-60	Bengal, and AFTER the Revolt . Cultivators refused to grow indigo under the planters' advance system. Notably successful , and it led to the Indigo Commission . Connected to Session 2's commercialisation
Pabna agrarian league	1873	Eastern Bengal, tenants against zamindars' illegal rent enhancement; contributed to the Bengal Tenancy Act 1885
DECCAN RIOTS	1875	Maharashtra, ryots against moneylenders under the Ryotwari system's cash demands; led to the Deccan Agriculturists' Relief Act 1879
MUNDA ulgulan	1899-1900	Chotanagpur, led by BIRSA MUNDA , against land alienation and forced labour. Produced the CHOTANAGPUR TENANCY ACT 1908 , a genuine legislative outcome. Birsa is the single most asked tribal leader

The principal uprisings - note which are before and which after 1857

The pattern worth stating, because it is the analytical content: almost every one of these risings produced legislation. The Indigo Commission, the Bengal Tenancy Act, the Deccan Agriculturists' Relief Act, the Chotanagpur Tenancy Act. **Rebellion was the mechanism by which agrarian grievance entered the statute book** - and that is a recognisable point about how protective legislation actually arrives, which connects directly to how the labour statutes of Module 2 came about.

MUST MASTER · THE REVOLT OF 1857 - CAUSES IN FIVE GROUPS

POLITICAL - Dalhousie's annexations under the **Doctrine of Lapse**, above all **Jhansi (1853)** and **Nagpur**; the **annexation of AWADH in 1856** on grounds of misgovernment, which dispossessed a loyal ally; the refusal of **Nana Saheb's** pension; and the announcement that **Bahadur Shah's** successors would lose the imperial title.

ECONOMIC - the revenue settlements' **high and inflexible demands**, the ruin of **artisans** by de-industrialisation, and the displacement of the **taluqdars and petty landholders of Awadh** by summary settlement.

SOCIAL AND RELIGIOUS - reforming legislation (**sati, widow remarriage**) read as interference; **missionary activity**; and the **Religious Disabilities Act of 1850**, which allowed a convert to inherit and was widely understood as state encouragement of conversion.

MILITARY - the **sepoy grievances, and these are the proximate ones:**

- 1 **Blocked promotion** - no Indian could rise above the rank of subedar, whatever his ability
- 2 **Pay and allowances**, including the withdrawal of **batta** (field allowance) for service in annexed territories
- 3 **The GENERAL SERVICE ENLISTMENT ACT, 1856**, requiring sepoys to serve **overseas**, which for many meant loss of caste
- 4 **The ratio of British to Indian troops was low**, so the army's own composition made a rising feasible
- 5 **A very large proportion of the Bengal Army was recruited from AWADH** - so the annexation of Awadh was a grievance felt inside the barracks

IMMEDIATE CAUSE - the **ENFIELD P-53 rifle**. Its cartridges had to be **bitten open**, and the grease was rumoured to be **cow and pig fat** - offensive to Hindu and Muslim sepoys alike. **This is the standard answer to "immediate cause", and note what makes it potent: it was credible precisely because the other grievances had already destroyed trust.** A rumour lands only in prepared ground.

THE SEQUENCE: MANGAL PANDEY of the 34th Native Infantry attacked his officers at **BARRACKPORE on 29 MARCH 1857** and was executed. **The Revolt proper began at MEERUT on 10 MAY 1857**, and the sepoys marched on **Delhi**, where they proclaimed the aged **BAHADUR SHAH ZAFAR** as emperor - **which gave the rising a symbol of legitimacy and, at the same time, a leader incapable of directing it.**

4.2 The centres, and why the Revolt failed

Centre	Leader	Note
DELHI	BAHADUR SHAH ZAFAR , with GENERAL BAKHT KHAN in actual command	The symbolic capital of the Revolt. Bakht Khan is the name asked, because Bahadur Shah was a figurehead
KANPUR	NANA SAHEB , with TANTIA TOPE and Azimullah Khan	Nana Saheb was the adopted son of the last Peshwa, denied his pension
LUCKNOW	BEGUM HAZRAT MAHAL , for her son Birjis Qadr	Awadh, and the most sustained resistance
JHANSI and then GWALIOR	RANI LAKSHMIBAI	Dispossessed under the Doctrine of Lapse in 1853. Died in action in 1858 ; the best-known figure of the Revolt
BAREILLY	KHAN BAHADUR KHAN	Rohilkhand
Bihar (Jagdishpur)	KUNWAR SINGH	An elderly zamindar, and the leading figure in Bihar
Faizabad	MAULVI AHMADULLAH SHAH	A notable organiser, and evidence that the Revolt had leadership beyond the dispossessed princes

The 1857 centre-to-leader pairings - the cheapest marks in the chapter

WHY THIS EXISTS · WHY IT FAILED - SIX REASONS, AND THEY ARE ASKED AS A SET

- 1 **Limited geographic spread.** The Revolt was confined largely to **the Ganga plain and central India. The south, most of Bengal, and the Punjab remained quiet** - and the Punjab supplied troops to suppress it
- 2 **No unified leadership or common programme.** Each centre fought its own war, under its own leader, for its own restoration. **Bahadur Shah was a symbol, not a commander**, and there was **no coordination between Delhi, Kanpur and Lucknow**
- 3 **Most Indian rulers stayed loyal to the British**, and actively helped - **Scindia of Gwalior, the Nizam of Hyderabad, the Sikh rulers, and the rulers of Nepal**. Canning later remarked that they acted as breakwaters in a storm
- 4 **The educated middle class stood aloof.** The new professional and commercial classes saw the rebels as representing **the old order they had no wish to restore** - and this is the point that most shapes the "nature of the Revolt" debate
- 5 **Material and technical superiority.** Better weapons, and crucially **the TELEGRAPH**, which let the British concentrate force faster than the rebels could coordinate. **The rebels had no equivalent of it, and one sepoy reportedly called the telegraph "the accursed string that strangled us"**
- 6 **Sepoy localism and indiscipline.** Many sepoys fought for local restoration and drifted home; there was no sustained supply or command system

The most defensible one-sentence answer: it failed because it was a coalition of local grievances without a common political programme, against an opponent with unified command and faster communications. Notice that this is a failure of ORGANISATION rather than of courage or numbers - the same analytical point this manual has made about the Mauryan state, Buddhist monasticism and the Mughal jagir system.

MUST MASTER · THE CONSEQUENCES - THE CONSTITUTIONAL SETTLEMENT OF 1858

The Revolt's most important results are constitutional, and they are heavily examined.

- 1 **GOVERNMENT OF INDIA ACT, 1858** - **abolished the East India Company** and transferred government to the **CROWN**. Created a **SECRETARY OF STATE FOR INDIA**, a cabinet minister answerable to Parliament, with a **Council of India** to advise him. **The Governor-General was retitled VICEROY**, the first being **Canning**
- 2 **QUEEN VICTORIA'S PROCLAMATION, 1 November 1858**, read at Allahabad. Its promises are asked: **the Doctrine of Lapse was ABANDONED and existing treaties with princes guaranteed; no further territorial expansion; non-interference in religion; and admission of Indians to office without discrimination as to race or creed** - the last again honoured mainly in the breach
- 3 **BAHADUR SHAH ZAFAR was tried and exiled to RANGOON, where he died in 1862 - the end of the Mughal dynasty**, three hundred and thirty-two years after Babur
- 4 **ARMY REORGANISATION**, and this is the substantive change: **the proportion of British to Indian troops was RAISED; artillery was reserved to Europeans**; recruitment shifted towards groups deemed **"martial races"** and away from Awadh and Bengal; and units were **deliberately mixed by caste, region and religion so that a common grievance could not easily form. This is divide-and-rule as an explicit organisational principle, and it is examinable as such**
- 5 **Racial distance widened**, and the paternalist confidence of the reforming era gave way to caution about interference in Indian society

The point to carry: the Revolt failed militarily and succeeded in changing the constitution of British India. It ended Company rule, ended annexation as policy, and ended the reforming impulse. **A defeated rebellion that reshapes the state it fought is a genuinely interesting outcome, and worth saying in those words.**

BEGINNER MISTAKE · THE NATURE OF THE REVOLT - GIVE THE COMPETING READINGS, NEVER A SINGLE VERDICT

This is the classic essay question of the period, and the honest answer names the positions.

- 1 **"A sepoy mutiny and nothing more"** - the contemporary British view, and that of some later writers. **Evidence for it: it began in the army, over army grievances, and the civilian risings followed the sepoys**
- 2 **"The first war of Indian independence"** - **V. D. SAVARKAR's** formulation, and the one adopted in much nationalist writing. **Evidence for it: the scale, the participation of civilians and peasants, the proclamations issued in the name of a common cause, and the Hindu-Muslim cooperation**
- 3 **"A feudal reaction - the last effort of the old order"** - associated with **R. C. Majumdar** and others. **Evidence for it: the leaders were dispossessed princes and taluqdars seeking restoration, the educated classes stayed away, and no rebel proclamation proposed anything new**
- 4 **The intermediate position, associated with S. N. Sen: it began as a mutiny and became a war of independence** - which concedes both the origin and the scale

The formulation to use: it began as a military mutiny, drew in agrarian and dynastic grievance to become a broad north Indian rebellion, and lacked any programme beyond restoration - so calling it a national war of independence claims too much, and calling it merely a mutiny claims too little. State the evidence, then the qualified verdict. A panel is testing whether you can hold a contested question open, and **the candidate who declares confidently for one label has failed the actual test.**

CHECK YOURSELF · SESSION 4

- 1 Distinguish the typical causes of tribal from peasant risings
- 2 Name the Santhal leaders, the region and the years
- 3 Who led the Munda ulgulan, when, and what Act followed?
- 4 State the pattern connecting the uprisings to legislation
- 5 Give the five groups of causes of 1857, with two examples from each
- 6 What was the General Service Enlistment Act, and why did it matter?
- 7 State the immediate cause, and why a rumour was sufficient
- 8 Give the date and place of Mangal Pandey's action, and of the Revolt's start
- 9 Pair Delhi, Kanpur, Lucknow, Jhansi, Bareilly and Bihar with their leaders
- 10 Give the six reasons for failure, and the one-sentence answer
- 11 State four provisions of the 1858 Act and four promises of the Proclamation
- 12 Give the four army reorganisation measures
- 13 Name the four readings of the Revolt's nature, with the evidence for each

ACTION · WHERE THIS LEAVES YOU, AND WHAT F5.10 DOES

You now hold the whole of the pre-1857 modern period: how the Company acquired power, the three land settlements and their consequences, the economic transformation and the drain, the reform movements with their legislation, the uprisings, and the Revolt with its constitutional aftermath.

F5.10 takes the freedom movement from 1885 to 1947 - the founding of the Congress, Moderates and Extremists, the Partition of Bengal and Swadeshi, the Home Rule and Gandhian movements, the Revolutionaries, the constitutional advances of 1909, 1919 and 1935, and Partition and Independence.

And it takes something else, which is why it is the chapter that finally joins Module 5 to the rest of this manual: THE LABOUR MOVEMENT. The first Indian factory legislation, the founding of the **AITUC in 1920**, the Royal Commission on Labour, the early trade disputes machinery and the Provident Fund debates of the 1940s **are the direct prehistory of the statutes you learned in Module 2 and of the organisation you are being recruited into.** F5.10 is where the history you have been studying for eight chapters arrives at your own desk.

5. Graded Practice - 42 Questions ★★★★★

5.1 Level 1 - Recognition

Q. 1. The Battle of Plassey was fought in

(a) 1757 (b) 1764 (c) 1765 (d) 1772

Q. 2. The Battle of Buxar was fought in

(a) 1757 (b) 1764 (c) 1793 (d) 1857

Q. 3. The Diwani of Bengal, Bihar and Orissa was granted to the Company in

(a) 1757 (b) 1764 (c) 1765 (d) 1773

Q. 4. The Permanent Settlement is associated with

(a) Thomas Munro (b) Lord Wellesley (c) Holt Mackenzie (d) Lord Cornwallis

Q. 5. The Ryotwari settlement is associated with

(a) Thomas Munro (b) Lord Cornwallis (c) R. M. Bird (d) Lord Dalhousie

Q. 6. The Mahalwari settlement was applied chiefly in

(a) Bengal and Bihar (b) Madras and Bombay (c) Assam and Berar (d) the North-Western Provinces and Punjab

Q. 7. The Subsidiary Alliance system is associated with

(a) Wellesley (b) Clive (c) Dalhousie (d) Cornwallis

Q. 8. The Doctrine of Lapse is associated with

(a) Wellesley (b) Dalhousie (c) Bentinck (d) Canning

Q. 9. The Brahmo Samaj was founded by

(a) Dayanand Saraswati (b) Vivekananda (c) Keshab Chandra Sen (d) Raja Ram Mohan Roy

Q. 10. The Arya Samaj was founded by

(a) Dayanand Saraswati (b) Raja Ram Mohan Roy (c) M. G. Ranade (d) Syed Ahmad Khan

Q. 11. The Satyarth Prakash was written by

(a) Ram Mohan Roy (b) Dayanand Saraswati (c) Jyotiba Phule (d) Vidyasagar

Q. 12. The Satyashodhak Samaj was founded by

(a) Sri Narayana Guru (b) R. G. Bhandarkar (c) Jyotiba Phule (d) Annie Besant

Q. 13. Sati was abolished in

(a) 1813 (b) 1829 (c) 1843 (d) 1856

Q. 14. The Hindu Widows' Remarriage Act was passed in

(a) 1829 (b) 1843 (c) 1856 (d) 1891

Q. 15. The Revolt of 1857 broke out at Meerut on

(a) 29 March 1857 (b) 1 November 1858 (c) 11 May 1857 (d) 10 May 1857

Q. 16. Rani Lakshmibai led the Revolt at

(a) Jhansi (b) Lucknow (c) Kanpur (d) Bareilly

5.2 Level 2 - Understanding

Q. 17. Dual Government in Bengal was ended in 1772 by

(a) Robert Clive (b) Warren Hastings (c) Cornwallis (d) Wellesley

Q. 18. Pitt's India Act of 1784 created the

(a) Supreme Court at Calcutta (b) office of Viceroy (c) Board of Control (d) Council of India

Q. 19. The Charter Act of 1833 is notable for

(a) ending the Company's monopoly of Indian trade (b) abolishing the Company (c) introducing open competition for the civil service (d) making the Governor-General of Bengal the Governor-General of India and ending the Company's commercial functions

Q. 20. Under the Permanent Settlement, the revenue demand was

(a) fixed in perpetuity (b) revised every twenty years (c) assessed on the village as a body (d) collected directly from each cultivator

Q. 21. Zamindars under the Permanent Settlement generally did not invest in improving land because

(a) they were forbidden to do so (b) income could be raised far more easily by increasing the tenant's rent (c) the state took all additional produce (d) they held no heritable interest

Q. 22. The theory of the drain of wealth was set out by

(a) R. C. Dutt alone (b) Lord Dalhousie (c) Dadabhai Naoroji in Poverty and Un-British Rule in India (d) Syed Ahmad Khan

Q. 23. India's first railway line, opened in 1853, ran from

(a) Calcutta to Raniganj (b) Delhi to Meerut (c) Madras to Arcot (d) Bombay to Thane

Q. 24. Macaulay's Minute of 1835 settled that state education would be

(a) through English and western learning (b) in the vernacular languages (c) confined to Sanskrit and Persian classical studies (d) left to missionary societies

Q. 25. Wood's Despatch of 1854 is called the Magna Carta of English education in India, and it led to the founding in 1857 of universities at

(a) Delhi, Lahore and Allahabad (b) Calcutta, Bombay and Madras (c) Aligarh, Banaras and Pune (d) Patna, Nagpur and Mysore

Q. 26. Swami Vivekananda addressed the Parliament of Religions at Chicago in

(a) 1875 (b) 1885 (c) 1893 (d) 1897

Q. 27. The essential contrast between the Aligarh and Deoband movements is that

(a) both were orthodox and anti-colonial (b) Aligarh was orthodox while Deoband favoured English education (c) Aligarh sought modern education and was loyalist in politics, while Deoband was orthodox and anti-colonial (d) neither concerned itself with education

Q. 28. The immediate cause of the Revolt of 1857 was

(a) the annexation of Awadh (b) the Religious Disabilities Act (c) the Doctrine of Lapse (d) the greased cartridges of the new Enfield rifle

Q. 29. Mangal Pandey's attack on his officers took place at

(a) Barrackpore (b) Meerut (c) Delhi (d) Kanpur

Q. 30. Queen Victoria's Proclamation of 1858 promised, among other things,

(a) immediate self-government (b) abandonment of the Doctrine of Lapse, guarantee of existing treaties and non-interference in religion (c) an elected legislature (d) abolition of the zamindari system

5.3 Level 3 - Recruitment Test standard

Q. 31. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the code below:

List-I (Measure)	List-II (Associated with)
A. Permanent Settlement	1. Thomas Munro
B. Ryotwari settlement	2. Lord Wellesley
C. Mahalwari settlement	3. Lord Cornwallis
D. Subsidiary Alliance	4. Holt Mackenzie

(a) A-3 B-4 C-1 D-2 (b) A-1 B-3 C-4 D-2 (c) A-3 B-1 C-4 D-2 (d) A-2 B-1 C-4 D-3

Q. 32. Which one of the following statements about the Permanent Settlement is NOT correct?

(a) It was introduced by Cornwallis in 1793 (b) The revenue demand was fixed in perpetuity (c) It applied to Bengal, Bihar and Orissa (d) The demand was revised every thirty years

Q. 33. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the code below:

List-I (Centre in 1857)	List-II (Leader)
A. Delhi	1. Nana Saheb
B. Kanpur	2. Rani Lakshmibai
C. Lucknow	3. General Bakht Khan
D. Jhansi	4. Begum Hazrat Mahal

(a) A-3 B-1 C-4 D-2 (b) A-1 B-3 C-4 D-2 (c) A-3 B-4 C-1 D-2 (d) A-4 B-1 C-3 D-2

Q. 34. Consider the following statements about de-industrialisation: 1. Indian goods entering Britain faced heavy duties while British goods entered India at nominal rates. · 2. The annexation of Indian states removed court patronage for luxury crafts. · 3. India ended the period exporting cloth and importing raw cotton. Which are correct?

(a) 1 only (b) 1 and 2 only (c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Q. 35. Which one of the following statements about the nineteenth-century reform movements is NOT correct?

(a) They were largely urban, upper-caste and English-educated in membership (b) The movements of Phule and Sri Narayana Guru were significant exceptions to that pattern (c) They transformed the condition of the rural majority within the period (d) Several argued from indigenous texts rather than only from European ideas

Q. 36. Arrange the following in correct chronological order, earliest first: 1. Permanent Settlement · 2. Battle of Plassey · 3. Revolt of 1857 · 4. Battle of Buxar

(a) 2-4-3-1 (b) 2-1-4-3 (c) 4-2-1-3 (d) 2-4-1-3

Q. 37. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the code below:

List-I (Organisation)	List-II (Founder or leader)
A. Brahmo Samaj	1. Jyotiba Phule
B. Prarthana Samaj	2. Raja Ram Mohan Roy
C. Satyashodhak Samaj	3. Syed Ahmad Khan
D. Aligarh movement	4. M. G. Ranade

(a) A-2 B-4 C-1 D-3 (b) A-2 B-1 C-4 D-3 (c) A-4 B-2 C-1 D-3 (d) A-1 B-4 C-2 D-3

Q. 38. Which one of the following statements about the Revolt of 1857 is NOT correct?

(a) It broke out at Meerut on 10 May 1857 (b) It spread across the whole subcontinent, including the southern presidencies (c) Bahadur Shah Zafar was proclaimed emperor at Delhi (d) Its immediate cause was the greased cartridges of the Enfield rifle

Q. 39. Consider the following statements about the Subsidiary Alliance: 1. The Indian ruler paid for a British force stationed in his territory. · 2. He surrendered control of his foreign relations to the Company. · 3. Hyderabad was the first state to accept it. Which are correct?

(a) 1 only (b) 1 and 2 only (c) 1, 2 and 3 (d) 2 and 3 only

Q. 40. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the code below:

List-I (Act)	List-II (Principal provision)
A. Regulating Act, 1773	1. Governor-General of India, and end of commercial functions
B. Pitt's India Act, 1784	2. Board of Control, establishing dual control
C. Charter Act, 1833	3. Open competition for the civil service
D. Charter Act, 1853	4. Governor-General of Bengal, and a Supreme Court at Calcutta

(a) A-1 B-2 C-4 D-3 (b) A-4 B-1 C-2 D-3 (c) A-2 B-4 C-1 D-3 (d) A-4 B-2 C-1 D-3

Q. 41. Which one of the following statements about the drain of wealth is NOT correct?

(a) Its magnitude is precisely established and undisputed among historians (b) Its components included the Home Charges and interest on debt raised in Britain (c) It operated through India's export surplus being absorbed in unrequited payments (d) It was set out by Dadabhai Naoroji in Poverty and Un-British Rule in India

Q. 42. Consider the following statements about the consequences of the Revolt of 1857: 1. The East India Company was abolished and government transferred to the Crown. · 2. The Doctrine of Lapse was abandoned and existing treaties with princes were guaranteed. · 3. The proportion of British to Indian troops in the army was reduced. Which are correct?

(a) 1 only (b) 1 and 2 only (c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

6. Answers and Explanations

6.1 Level 1 - answers

Q	Ans	Why, and why the others fail
1	a	1757 - Clive against Siraj-ud-Daulah , won largely by subverting Mir Jafar . Plassey gave influence; Buxar gave supremacy; the Diwani gave revenue - hold the three as a chain
2	b	1764 - against the combined forces of Mir Qasim, Shuja-ud-Daulah of Awadh and the Mughal emperor Shah Alam II . This is why Buxar matters more than Plassey: they beat a real coalition including the emperor
3	c	1765 , granted by Shah Alam II - the constitutional turning point, because a revenue authority is a government
4	d	Cornwallis, 1793 , in Bengal, Bihar and Orissa, with the zamindar as proprietor and the demand fixed in perpetuity
5	a	Thomas Munro (with Captain Read), in the Madras and Bombay presidencies, dealing directly with the individual cultivator
6	d	The North-Western Provinces, Central Provinces and Punjab , assessed on the village or mahal as a body . (a) is Permanent Settlement territory and (b) Ryotwari - the three regions are as examinable as the three names
7	a	Wellesley . (c) Dalhousie is the Doctrine of Lapse , and this pair is the most common confusion in the chapter
8	b	Dalhousie - and note that Awadh in 1856 was annexed on grounds of MISGOVERNMENT, not lapse , which is a favourite distinction
9	d	Raja Ram Mohan Roy, 1828 - conventionally the father of the Indian Renaissance, whose campaign produced the abolition of sati. (c) Keshab Chandra Sen was a later leader under whom the Samaj split
10	a	Dayanand Saraswati, 1875 - "back to the Vedas", revivalist in doctrine and radical in social effect
11	b	Dayanand Saraswati - the Arya Samaj's principal text
12	c	Jyotiba Phule, 1873 - the most important lower-caste movement of the period , and the one that organised from below rather than reforming from above
13	b	1829 , under Lord William Bentinck
14	c	1856 , following Vidyasagar's campaign - and note his method, arguing from within the Sanskrit texts rather than against them

Q	Ans	Why, and why the others fail
15	d	10 May 1857. (a) 29 March is Mangal Pandey at Barrackpore; (c) 11 May is the sepoys' arrival at Delhi. Three dates, three events, six weeks apart
16	a	Jhansi, and later Gwalior; she had been dispossessed under the Doctrine of Lapse in 1853 and died in action in 1858

6.2 Level 2 - answers

Q	Ans	Why, and why the others fail
17	b	Warren Hastings, 1772. (a) Clive CREATED the system in 1765 - the trap is that both names attach to it, at opposite ends
18	c	The Board of Control, establishing dual control: the Company traded and administered while the Crown supervised. (a) The Supreme Court came with the Regulating Act 1773
19	d	Governor-General of India and the end of commercial functions. (a) belongs to 1813 and (c) to 1853 - three Charter Acts, three different provisions, and the paper tests exactly this separation
20	a	Fixed in perpetuity - which gave the state certainty and transferred all variation risk to the zamindar, and meant that as prices rose over the next century the entire gain accrued to zamindars and none to the state
21	b	Raising the tenant's rent was far easier than improving the land. The incentive pointed at rent extraction rather than productivity, and nothing in the settlement protected the tenant - a failure of incentive design, not of effort
22	c	Naoroji, in Poverty and Un-British Rule in India. (a) R. C. Dutt also wrote on it, so "alone" is what makes (a) wrong. Its political significance was to give the early nationalists an ECONOMIC case against British rule
23	d	Bombay to Thane, 1853, under Dalhousie. Note the design point: the lines ran from the interior to the ports, which is the geometry of extraction, and investors' returns were guaranteed by the Indian government
24	a	English and western learning, over classical Sanskrit and Persian education. Its "filtration theory" assumed education would percolate downwards from a thin upper layer, and it did not
25	b	Calcutta, Bombay and Madras, founded in 1857 - the year of the Revolt, which is a useful coincidence for remembering it
26	c	1893 at the Parliament of Religions. (d) 1897 is the founding of the Ramakrishna Mission - the two dates are four years apart and are routinely swapped
27	c	Aligarh sought modern education and was loyalist; Deoband was orthodox and anti-colonial. The pair is the standard question, and each is defined partly against the other
28	d	The greased cartridges of the Enfield P-53, which had to be bitten open. (a), (c) and (b) are all genuine underlying causes - which is the point: the rumour was potent precisely because the other grievances had already destroyed trust
29	a	Barrackpore, 29 March 1857, of the 34th Native Infantry. (b) Meerut is where the Revolt proper began six weeks later
30	b	Abandonment of the Doctrine of Lapse, guarantee of existing treaties, and non-interference in religion - plus admission of Indians to office without racial discrimination, honoured mainly in the breach. (a) and (c) are anachronistic by decades

6.3 Level 3 - answers

Q	Ans	Why, and why the others fail
31	c	A-3 Permanent Settlement-Cornwallis · B-1 Ryotwari-Munro · C-4 Mahalwari-Holt Mackenzie · D-2 Subsidiary Alliance-Wellesley. Knowing only Cornwallis and Wellesley resolves the code
32	d	(d) is false and contradicts (b). The whole point of the settlement is that the demand was fixed in perpetuity and never revised - which is why Ryotwari and Mahalwari were deliberately made periodic , the government having learned from it
33	a	A-3 Delhi-Bakht Khan · B-1 Kanpur-Nana Saheb · C-4 Lucknow-Begum Hazrat Mahal · D-2 Jhansi-Rani Lakshmibai. Bakht Khan is the answer for Delhi because Bahadur Shah was a figurehead - a question naming Delhi expects the actual commander
34	b	1 and 2 only. Statement 3 reverses the direction of trade: India began the period as the world's largest producer of cotton textiles and ended it exporting raw cotton and importing cloth. The tariff asymmetry in statement 1 is the decisive mechanism , which is why "free competition" does not describe what happened
35	c	(c) is false, and the qualification is what makes an answer credible. The movements were largely urban and upper-caste, touching the rural majority only slightly - with Phule and Narayana Guru the significant exceptions . (a), (b) and (d) are all correct
36	d	2-4-1-3: Plassey 1757, Buxar 1764, Permanent Settlement 1793, Revolt 1857. Four dates that frame the whole chapter
37	a	A-2 Brahmo Samaj-Ram Mohan Roy · B-4 Prarthana Samaj-Ranade · C-1 Satyashodhak Samaj-Phule · D-3 Aligarh-Syed Ahmad Khan. The Prarthana Samaj is essentially the Brahmo Samaj in western India , which is why those two are placed together in the list
38	b	(b) is false, and it is the first of the six reasons the Revolt failed. It was confined largely to the Ganga plain and central India; the south, most of Bengal and the Punjab stayed quiet , and the Punjab supplied troops for its suppression. (a), (c) and (d) are correct
39	c	All three are correct. And the analytical point is that the ruler paid for the army that contained him , on terms usually above what his state could afford, so arrears accumulated and territory was ceded in settlement - while a protection guarantee let his own military capacity decay
40	d	A-4 1773-Governor-General of Bengal and a Supreme Court · B-2 1784-Board of Control and dual control · C-1 1833-Governor-General of India and end of commercial functions · D-3 1853-open competition for the civil service. The Acts are a favourite matching set because their provisions are easily swapped
41	a	(a) is false. The mechanism of the drain is well established and should be stated confidently, but the magnitude is contested and estimates vary widely - so the correct posture is mechanism with confidence, figures as estimates . (d), (b) and (c) are all accurate
42	b	1 and 2 only. Statement 3 inverts the actual measure: the proportion of British to Indian troops was RAISED , artillery was reserved to Europeans, and units were deliberately mixed by caste, region and religion so that a common grievance could not form - divide and rule as an explicit organisational principle

7. One-Minute Revision

ONE-MINUTE REVISION · CHAPTER F5.9 - MODERN INDIA TO 1857

HOW THIS CHAPTER DIFFERS the evidence is abundant, the institutions still exist, and **dates matter more** - so "why" questions become possible · but the paper is still objective, so **most questions remain pairings** · and this is the period an SBI officer half knows already: **the Permanent Settlement is a credit decision, de-industrialisation a terms-of-trade story, the drain a balance-of-payments argument**

FROM TRADE TO TERRITORY Company chartered **1600**, first factory **SURAT 1613 · PLASSEY 1757** - Clive beat **Siraj-ud-Daulah** by subverting **MIR JAFAR**, so it is a successful conspiracy more than a battle · **BUXAR 1764** - beat **Mir Qasim + Shuja-ud-Daulah of Awadh + the emperor SHAH ALAM II**, and **this is what established military supremacy · DIWANI 1765** - the right to collect the revenue of **Bengal, Bihar, Orissa**, the constitutional turning point · **DUAL GOVERNMENT 1765-72** (Clive) - **Company held the diwani, Nawab kept the nizamat**, responsibility split from power, **Bengal famine 1770, ended by WARREN HASTINGS 1772 · the chain: Plassey gave influence, Buxar supremacy, the Diwani revenue - and the Company conquered India substantially with INDIAN MONEY**

THE TWO DEVICES SUBSIDIARY ALLIANCE (WELLESLEY) - ruler accepts a British force **and pays for it**, surrenders **foreign relations**, accepts a **Resident**, employs no other Europeans; Company guarantees him against attack and rebellion · **the ruler paid for the army that contained him**; subsidies exceeded capacity, **arrears accumulated and territory was ceded**, and the protection guarantee let his own forces decay · **Hyderabad first, 1798**; then Mysore, Awadh, the Marathas · **DOCTRINE OF LAPSE (DALHOUSIE)** - no natural heir means the state lapses, **adopted heirs refused · Satara first 1848**, then Jaitpur, Sambalpur, Udaipur, **JHANSI 1853, Nagpur 1854 · AWADH 1856 was annexed for MISGOVERNMENT, NOT lapse · Wellesley made rulers dependent, Dalhousie dispossessed them - and both feed 1857**

THE THREE SETTLEMENTS - the certain question **PERMANENT - CORNWALLIS 1793** - Bengal, Bihar, Orissa - the **ZAMINDAR** pays - **FIXED IN PERPETUITY · RYOTWARI - MUNRO and READ - Madras and Bombay** - the **RYOT** pays directly - revised, and he bears the whole harvest risk · **MAHALWARI - HOLT MACKENZIE and BIRD - NW Provinces, Central Provinces, PUNJAB** - the **VILLAGE** pays as a body, with joint liability

WHY THE PERMANENT SETTLEMENT FAILED - read it as a **credit decision** a fixed demand bought **certainty** and **transferred all variation risk to the zamindar** · but **it was too high and inflexible**, so many defaulted and estates were sold; the **incentive pointed at raising RENT** rather than yield, with nothing protecting the tenant; and **perpetuity** meant a century of rising prices went to zamindars, not the state · **the lesson: it optimised for the collector's certainty rather than the producer's capacity - which is why Ryotwari and Mahalwari were made periodic**

THE ECONOMY COMMERCIALISATION - indigo, opium, cotton, jute, tea; **not a free choice**, because revenue was demanded in **CASH**, and the result is **vulnerability to a world price the cultivator cannot see · DE-INDUSTRIALISATION** - machine competition, **TARIFF ASYMMETRY** (heavy duties on Indian goods into Britain, nominal duties on British goods into India) - the **decisive mechanism**, and lost court patronage · **India went from the world's largest cotton-textile producer to exporting raw cotton and importing cloth · THE DRAIN - DADABHAI NAOROJI, "Poverty and Un-British Rule in India"** - Home Charges, pensions, interest on Britain-raised debt, remittances · **mechanism: an export surplus absorbed in UNREQUITED payments, so India ran a trade surplus and got nothing for it · mechanism confidently, magnitude as contested · first railway BOMBAY-THANE 1853, but lines ran interior-to-port and investors' returns were guaranteed by India**

REFORM - two strategies REFORMIST = concede and change, often by legislation (**Brahmo, Prarthana, Aligarh**) · **REVIVALIST** = the practices are later corruptions, so return to a purer original (**Arya Samaj**) · and revivalism can be **MORE effective socially, because it does not require conceding that the tradition was wrong** · **Dayanand opposed caste by birth while claiming the highest possible authority for doing so**

THE MOVEMENTS **BRAHMO SAMAJ - RAM MOHAN ROY 1828**, father of the Indian Renaissance, sati abolished 1829 under **BENTINCK** · **VIDYASAGAR - Widow Remarriage Act 1856**, and he argued from within the shastras · **PRARTHANA SAMAJ 1867 - RANADE and BHANDARKAR** · **ARYA SAMAJ - DAYANAND 1875**, "back to the Vedas", **SATYARTH PRAKASH, shuddhi** · **RAMAKRISHNA MISSION - VIVEKANANDA 1897, CHICAGO 1893** · **SATYASHODHAK SAMAJ - PHULE 1873**, Gulamgiri, with **Savitribai** schools for girls - **organised from below** · **THEOSOPHICAL SOCIETY - Adyar**, later **ANNIE BESANT** · **ALIGARH - SYED AHMAD KHAN, 1875**, loyalist · **DEOBAND 1866 - orthodox and ANTI-COLONIAL** · **SNDP - SRI NARAYANA GURU**, Ezhavas, temple entry

THE LEGISLATION SATI 1829 · SLAVERY 1843 · WIDOW REMARRIAGE 1856 · AGE OF CONSENT 1891, bitterly opposed and it **split the nationalists between reformers and those who held social change must wait for political freedom** · the reform movements' honest verdict: they changed public debate, produced enabling legislation and created the class that made the national movement possible - while touching the rural majority only slightly **1857 - CAUSES IN FIVE GROUPS** **POLITICAL** lapse annexations, **Awadh 1856**, Nana Saheb's pension, the threat to Bahadur Shah's title · **ECONOMIC** inflexible revenue, ruined artisans, displaced Awadh taluqdars · **SOCIAL/RELIGIOUS** reforming laws read as interference, missionaries, **RELIGIOUS DISABILITIES ACT 1850** · **MILITARY** promotion blocked above **subedar, batta** withdrawn, **GENERAL SERVICE ENLISTMENT ACT 1856**, and **much of the Bengal Army recruited from AWADH** · **IMMEDIATE: the ENFIELD's greased cartridges - potent because the other grievances had already destroyed trust**

WHY IT FAILED - SIX limited spread - the Ganga plain and central India only, with **the south, most of Bengal and the PUNJAB quiet, and the Punjab supplying troops against it** · **no unified leadership or programme**, Bahadur Shah a symbol not a commander · **most Indian rulers stayed loyal** - Scindia, the Nizam, the Sikh rulers, Nepal · **the educated middle class stood aloof**, seeing the rebels as the old order · **material superiority and above all the TELEGRAPH**, letting the British concentrate faster than the rebels could coordinate · **sepoym localism** · **one sentence: a coalition of local grievances without a common political programme, against an opponent with unified command and faster communications - a failure of ORGANISATION**

CONSEQUENCES **GoI ACT 1858** - Company abolished, **CROWN rule, SECRETARY OF STATE**, Governor-General retitled **VICEROY (Canning)** · **QUEEN'S PROCLAMATION, 1 NOV 1858 - Lapse ABANDONED**, treaties guaranteed, no further expansion, **non-interference in religion** · **BAHADUR SHAH exiled to RANGOON - the Mughal dynasty ends** · **ARMY REORGANISED - British-to-Indian ratio RAISED**, artillery to Europeans, "martial races", units **MIXED** by caste, region and religion so a common grievance could not form - divide and rule by design · the Revolt failed militarily and changed the constitution of British India **THE NATURE DEBATE - give the readings, never one verdict "a sepoy mutiny and nothing more"** (contemporary British) - it began in the army over army grievances · **"the first war of independence"** (**SAVARKAR**) - scale, civilian participation, Hindu-Muslim cooperation · **"a feudal reaction, the last effort of the old order"** (**R. C. MAJUMDAR**) - the leaders were dispossessed princes, the educated stayed away, no proclamation proposed anything new · **the intermediate position (S. N. SEN): it began as a mutiny and became a war of independence** · the formulation: a military mutiny that drew in agrarian and dynastic grievance to become a broad north Indian rebellion, with no programme beyond restoration - so "national war of independence" claims too much and "mutiny" too little

8. Five-Minute Wall Sheet

FIVE-MINUTE WALL SHEET · CHAPTER F5.9 - MODERN INDIA TO 1857

Company chartered 1600 · first factory SURAT 1613

PLASSEY 1757 (Clive v Siraj-ud-Daulah, via MIR JAFAR) · BUXAR 1764 (v Mir Qasim + Awadh + SHAH ALAM II)

DIWANI 1765 = Bengal, Bihar, Orissa revenue = the Company becomes a government

DUAL GOVERNMENT 1765-72 (Clive) → Bengal famine 1770 → ended by WARREN HASTINGS 1772

1773 Regulating: GG of Bengal + Supreme Court · 1784 Pitt's: BOARD OF CONTROL, dual control

1813: ended trade monopoly · 1833: GG of INDIA, ended commercial functions · 1853: open ICS competition

SUBSIDIARY ALLIANCE = WELLESLEY · the ruler PAYS for the force that contains him · HYDERABAD first 1798

DOCTRINE OF LAPSE = DALHOUSIE · SATARA 1848, JHANSI 1853, NAGPUR 1854

AWADH 1856 = annexed for MISGOVERNMENT, not lapse

TIPU died 1799 · Marathas fell 1818 · PUNJAB annexed 1849 - paramountcy complete 8 years before the Revolt

PERMANENT SETTLEMENT: CORNWALLIS 1793 · Bengal-Bihar-Orissa · ZAMINDAR pays · FIXED IN PERPETUITY

RYOTWARI: MUNRO · Madras + Bombay · the RYOT pays direct · revised · ryot bears harvest risk

MAHALWARI: HOLT MACKENZIE + BIRD · NW Provinces + PUNJAB · the VILLAGE pays · joint liability

Zamindars didn't invest because raising RENT was easier than raising YIELD

Fixed in perpetuity = a century of rising prices went to zamindars, not the state

DE-INDUSTRIALISATION: machine competition + TARIFF ASYMMETRY (decisive) + lost court patronage

India went from the world's largest cloth producer to exporting RAW COTTON and importing CLOTH

DRAIN = DADABHAI NAOROJI, "Poverty and Un-British Rule in India" · Home Charges + interest + remittances

Mechanism: an export surplus absorbed in UNREQUITED payments · mechanism certain, magnitude contested

First railway BOMBAY-THANE 1853 (Dalhousie) · lines ran interior-to-PORT · guaranteed returns

MACAULAY'S MINUTE 1835 = English + western learning · WOOD'S DESPATCH 1854 = "Magna Carta"

Universities at CALCUTTA, BOMBAY, MADRAS founded 1857

BRAHMO SAMAJ = RAM MOHAN ROY 1828 · SATI ABOLISHED 1829 under BENTINCK

VIDYASAGAR → WIDOW REMARRIAGE ACT 1856 · argued from within the shastras

PRARTHANA SAMAJ 1867 = RANADE + BHANDARKAR · ARYA SAMAJ 1875 = DAYANAND, SATYARTH PRAKASH, shuddhi

RAMAKRISHNA MISSION 1897 = VIVEKANANDA · CHICAGO 1893

SATYASHODHAK SAMAJ 1873 = JYOTIBA PHULE · Gulamgiri · with SAVITRIBAI, schools for girls

ALIGARH = SYED AHMAD KHAN, modern education, LOYALIST · DEOBAND 1866 = orthodox, ANTI-COLONIAL

SNDP = SRI NARAYANA GURU, Kerala · AGE OF CONSENT ACT 1891 split the nationalists

SANTHAL (HuI) 1855-56 = SIDHU + KANHU · MUNDA ULGULAN 1899-1900 = BIRSA MUNDA

INDIGO REVOLT 1859-60 · DECCAN RIOTS 1875 (moneylenders) · almost every rising produced LEGISLATION

1857 IMMEDIATE CAUSE = ENFIELD greased cartridges · GENERAL SERVICE ENLISTMENT ACT 1856

MANGAL PANDEY: BARRACKPORE, 29 MARCH 1857 · REVOLT BEGINS: MEERUT, 10 MAY 1857

DELHI-BAKHT KHAN · KANPUR-NANA SAHEB + TANTIA TOPE · LUCKNOW-BEGUM HAZRAT MAHAL

JHANSI-RANI LAKSHMIBAI · BAREILLY-KHAN BAHADUR KHAN · BIHAR-KUNWAR SINGH · FAIZABAD-MAULVI AHMADULLAH

FAILED: limited spread · no common programme · rulers loyal · middle class aloof · the TELEGRAPH · localism

1858: Company ABOLISHED · CROWN rule · SECRETARY OF STATE · VICEROY (Canning)

PROCLAMATION 1 NOV 1858: LAPSE ABANDONED, treaties guaranteed, non-interference in religion

ARMY: British-to-Indian ratio RAISED, artillery to Europeans, units MIXED - divide and rule by design

BAHADUR SHAH exiled to RANGOON - the Mughal dynasty ends

NATURE: mutiny (British) · first war of independence (SAVARKAR) · feudal reaction (MAJUMDAR) · both (S. N. SEN)